

Composition





About the Course

Students continue to practice writing poetry and prose of various kinds while working on a few longer projects each term. Lessons topics include: logical fallacies, research and citation habits, narrative techniques, the ethics of communication, and more.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Language Study: Grade 11

Composition: Grade 11

In addition to their composition and grammar lessons, students should continue to keep track of their regular written narrations and write 5-10 each week. Not all narrations need to be lengthy, but students should be comfortable typing multiple paragraphs if given the time.



Placement & Combining Tips

Prerequisite: Students with little background in the essay form should begin with Essay Voyage from the Grade 9 lessons. And students new to the concept of revision and editing should take the Grade 10 courses.

Composition prompts often reference Alveary lessons in Literature, History, Geography, Bible, etc., so it is ideal if students are using Alveary subjects across the curriculum. However, lessons include the lesson topic and target skill/form, along with ideas for substitution when possible to make the lessons flexible for teachers and students.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
11	Composition: Grade 11 4 times/week 40 min	Advanced Academic Writing II Teacher Manual Communicating with Grace and Virtue: Learning to Listen, Speak, Text, and Interact as a Christian Steering the Craft: A Twenty-First Century Guide to Sailing the Sea of Story

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Language Study: Grade 11				
Composition: Grade 11	Composition: Grade 11	Composition: Grade 11	Commonplace: Grades 9-12	Composition: Grade 11



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

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- One purpose of composition lessons is to encourage you, the student, to dig deeper, self-reflect on your own thoughts and writing, and learn how to ask good questions of yourself and your readings. It isn't about proving to your teacher that you read a book or did an assignment.
- Set the timer and use the whole time allotted for a lesson. If you finish an assignment with extra time, explore another perspective, ask further questions, or take a bit more time to see if any other thoughts come to mind. Alternately, if you find yourself stuck, you may want to take a short break and come back later or break up the time into two shorter times. Growth, not frustration, is the goal.

Term Prep & Teacher Tips

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- Plan to have your student(s) type the majority of their narrations and compositions. See keyboarding course for resources on typing if needed.
- Encourage students to spend all the time left at the end of a lesson on their written narrations and the whole lesson time on their compositions, and give as much detail as possible. For their narrations, it may help if you encourage them to think of writing their narrations for a friend or someone who has never read the book, rather than for you, who might already know the story. If they feel like they've run out of things to write, have them try varying the type of narration they're writing (interview, sketch, letter, poem, etc.).



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

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Advanced Academic Writing II Teacher Manual



Communicating with Grace and Virtue: Learning to Listen, Speak, Text, and Interact as a Christian



Steering the Craft: A Twenty-First Century Guide to Sailing the Sea of Story



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Related Course Quick Links

∞ [Foundations \(See Sections 3 & 8: Narration & English\)](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



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How To Approach



Read

You will read books across the curriculum. Look for interesting quotes to copy into your commonplace book!



Practice

You will practice many forms of composition over the year. Your books will often serve as the foundation for your assignments, along with books specifically focused on composition.



Teacher Note

- As you review your students' composition assignments, be sure to read the instructions in the lesson and give feedback and support accordingly.
- Some students naturally integrate and incorporate ideas from grammar and composition lessons into their narrations and composition assignments, but most assignments ask students to focus on one skill or idea.
- For editing or revision lessons, hold the student accountable to work through the process and instructions given for editing, but refrain from suggesting too many ideas about how they could expand the essay or add another idea.
- For assignments that ask a student to focus on a particular concept, ignore spelling or grammar edits, and support your student by noticing what they've done well and drawing out ideas on how to dig deeper.

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Term 1

WEEK 1 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 1

Materials: Steering the Craft

→ READ & NARRATE

"Introduction"

→ WRITE

Write a list of the topics mentioned that you already know. Make notes on the topics that are new or that you are unsure about.

★ STUDENT/TEACHER NOTE

In addition to these more formal composition lessons, be sure to keep up the habit of written and oral narrations throughout the week. Aim for 8-10 written narrations per week, and use different ways of narrating to keep it interesting!

WEEK 1 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 2

Materials: Advanced Academic Writing II

→ INTRO

What is the value of writing? Of poetry, stories, essays, and biographies? Jot down your thoughts.

→ REVIEW

You've learned about structure before, but it's worth reviewing as you begin another year.

Advanced Academic Writing II
p.1,4-5

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

As you practice and read many different forms of writing over the year, continue to consider the questions at the beginning of this lesson. Why create anything with words (or other mediums)? Tolkien considers these questions (and many more) in his poem "Mythopoeia."

- Read the poem aloud. Underline phrases or words that stick out to you, and keep the questions above in your mind as you read.
- ∞ Poetry Link: Mythopoeia

- Why are words valuable to Tolkien? Why create stories or any other form of art?

★ STUDENT/TEACHER NOTE

You may write or type your narrations and compositions initially. But for these composition lessons, be sure to type the final draft you turn in to your teacher.

WEEK 1 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 3

Tech/Visual

→ CREATE

Sometimes, a "picture is worth a thousand words." Use this lesson to create an infographic by hand or in Canva, PowerPoint, or another design software. Look at some of the coffee infographics in the attached article to get a sense of the possibilities. Whether created digitally or by hand, visual illustrations are a powerful narration tool as well to help you understand what you read, so feel free to incorporate visuals into your daily narrations!

First, brainstorm what you want to illustrate. Here are some ideas:

- Show the process of conducting a science lab.
- Key events in your life or the life of a historical character you're reading about.
- Outline a sermon you've heard or key points from a chapter in one of your books.
- Your daily or weekly schedule.
- Your family tree.
- How to make your favorite recipe.
- Something else entirely!

∞ Article Link: Coffee Infographic

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Term 1

WEEK 1 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 4

Questions

→ INTRO

Charlotte Mason said that we only know what we ask ourselves questions about, and then can communicate to ourselves and others. She called all the different ways that we can narrate "forms of vitality." Here are her actual words:

One thing at any rate we know with certainty, that no teaching, no information becomes knowledge to any of us until the individual mind has acted upon it, translated it, transformed, absorbed it, to reappear, like our bodily food, in forms of vitality. Therefore, teaching, talk, and tale, however lucid or fascinating, affect nothing until self-activity be set up; that is, self-education is the only possible education; the rest is mere veneer laid on the surface of a child's nature (Vol. 6, p.240).

This is how we know and why we narrate. We help ourselves along in this process by developing the habit of asking good questions. A famous scientist named Louis Agassiz was a master at helping students see and observe more by learning to ask themselves questions about whatever they were studying. Read the account of one of his students when first being examined for the opportunity.

→ READ

p.96-100 "The examination"- "knowledge of fossils."
∞ Website Link: Autobiography of Nathaniel Shaler

→ WRITE

Write as many observations and questions about one of your readings as you have time for.

★ TEACHER/STUDENT NOTE

If you did Grade 10 Composition last year and remember the reading about Agassiz, skip to the WRITE assignment, or complete the whole lesson to refresh your memory. It's a good reminder!

WEEK 2 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 5

Materials: Steering the Craft

→ READ

Ch.1

- Think about examples from your reading. Listen for "the sound of writing" this week.

→ WRITE

Complete Part One of Exercise One: Being Gorgeous.

WEEK 2 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 6

What makes a good argument?

Materials: Advanced Academic Writing II

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.52-54

- Have you ever thought about research as re-searching before?
- To emphasize the argumentative and persuasive component of an essay, MCT writes, "our thesis is not a mere personal opinion; it is the truth." What MCT means is that writers should give their best effort to discern, research, and understand their claims and put forward a thesis they believe is true (not just their first impressions). What he does not mean is that writers should assume that their essays are the "last word" on a subject. Our job as writers is to do our best to explain the truth as we see it, while also recognizing that new discoveries and new perspectives may cause us to rethink or revise our opinions over time. We need to develop firm convictions but also hold them humbly. Write or discuss your

• ANSWER KEY

- Therefore, Socrates is mortal.
- Therefore, a dolphin has a backbone.

- **Therefore, an apple is blue.**

Note: For this syllogism, the premise is faulty, but the logic is sound.

- It is tempting to conclude "All Toyotas are hybrids," but this conclusion does not follow from the premises.



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	thoughts on this idea. → PRACTICE Write the conclusion that follows from these premises (or explain the problem with the syllogism). Don't look at the answer key until you're done! • All humans are mortal. Socrates is a human. • All mammals have a backbone. A dolphin is a mammal. • All fruits are blue. An apple is a fruit. • All Toyotas need fuel to run. A hybrid car needs fuel to run. → EXPLORE With extra time, explore how you can use Venn diagrams to visually think about the logical relationship between sentences. Try creating diagrams for the sentences above. ∞ Article Link: Syllogisms	
WEEK 2	40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 7 <i>Poetry</i> → WRITE Compose a poem that tells a story (either one you made up or a retelling of something you've read). Use the epic convention of starting "in media res" or in the middle of the action. For instance, if you are telling the story of your day, start with the moment you looked out the window and saw a hawk eat a worm, not the moment you woke up. Give your poem an intentional structure and label what it is (refer back to Making of a Poem from Grade 9 Poetry study for a list of forms if desired).	
WEEK 2	40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 8 <i>Inspection</i> → WRITE Gather 3 of your favorite books from the term so far, and reread the first few pages of each. Where does each author begin? How do they draw you into the story? What details do you notice in just the first few pages that give you a clue to what time period you're reading about, who the main character(s) is/are, what the purpose of the book is, what the genre is, and the author's style? Write down your findings. Think about a few of your other favorite books in general. What about them grabs your attention? Add to your findings.	
WEEK 3	40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 9 Materials: Steering the Craft → PRACTICE Ch.1 Repeat Exercise One: Being Gorgeous, and Complete Part Two.	
WEEK 3	40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 10 <i>Fallacies</i> Materials: Advanced Academic Writing II → INTRO Describe examples of bad arguments you've seen or heard. → READ p.55-57	★ STUDENT TIP Look for fallacies as you read and go about life!

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[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



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→ READ

∞ Article Link: Logical Fallacies

→ DISCUSS

Describe each of the fallacies you read about in your own words, or create a poster, sketch, spreadsheet, PowerPoint, or 3D model of each of them to help you visualize and understand them in a way that makes sense to you.

WEEK 3 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 11

Revision

→ INTRO

Good writers revise. Sometimes we imagine a writer sitting at a desk, scribbling away furiously, flowing sentences, and vivid lines of poetry or prose appearing on paper, instantly ready for publication. Unfortunately, as author Anne Lamott describes, "Almost all good writing begins with terrible first efforts. You need to start somewhere. Start by getting something - anything - down on paper. A friend of mine says that the first draft is the down draft -- you just get it down. The second draft is the up draft - you fix it up. You try to say what you have to say more accurately. And the third draft is the dental draft, where you check every tooth, to see if it's loose or cramped or decayed, or even, ... healthy" (Bird by Bird 24).

→ DISCUSS

Read this short blog on revision. What ideas are new to you? You might not agree with everything the author says, but take note of his main points.

∞ Article Link: On Revision

→ REVISE

Pick a previous narration that is at least two paragraphs long to revise and rewrite. Your goal is not just to make your writing free of punctuation or spelling errors, but to create a more polished version of your narration that you could share with someone to tell them about the particular topic you wrote about or the chapter you read.

Big-Picture Revision

1. If you have not already typed your narration, do that now so you have a digital version to edit.
2. Are there other ideas you've had more recently that you'd like to add to your narration? Do that now.
3. Look at your paragraphs. Are they indented and focused around one idea each? Describe that main idea in one sentence and consider making that the first sentence of your paragraph.
4. Try moving your paragraphs around in a different order. What order do you think might make the most sense to someone reading your words?

Sentence Level Revision

1. Read your narration aloud and fix any grammar or spelling errors you hear or see.
2. Make the main characters the subjects of sentences and important action verbs where possible.
3. How well do your sentences flow? Put old information before new information in your sentences.
4. Delete unnecessary words and change negatives to affirmatives.
5. Make sure your sentences are complete, not fragments.
6. Use Grammarly or another spell checker to find any other punctuation or spelling issues and fix those.

Share your revised narration with someone.

★ STUDENT TIP

Especially if revision is new to you, consider purchasing *Style: The Basics of Clarity and Grace* (used in Grade 10) to keep as a reference.

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WEEK 3 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 12

Point of View

→ WRITE

Write a narration as if you are inside the story and telling a first-hand account of what you're seeing! For instance, perhaps you're walking alongside Wordsworth, falsely imprisoned with Edmond Dantès, traveling with Lewis & Clark, or visiting another character in history. You can write it as a diary entry and tell your thoughts as you walk around inside the story. Or you could write it as a travel memoir and focus on describing what is going on to your audience. In either case, tell things from your first-person perspective.

WEEK 4 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 13

Materials: Steering the Craft

→ READ

Ch.2

→ PRACTICE

Complete Exercise Two.

WEEK 4 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 14

Identifying fallacies

Materials: Advanced Academic Writing II

→ REVIEW

p.55-57

∞ Article Link: Logical Fallacies

→ PRACTICE

Identify the fallacies in the following examples. (Check your work when you are done with the answer key in the next lesson).

1. Example: "You can't trust Jane's opinion on politics; she's an artist, not a politician."
2. Example: "People who support space exploration think that poverty on Earth is not a problem."
3. Example: "If we allow students to bring smartphones to class, soon they'll be bringing tablets and then laptops, and no one will be paying attention to the lesson."
4. Example: "Why worry about the deficit when there are so many people unemployed?"
5. Example: "No one has proven that aliens don't exist, so they must be out there."
6. Example: "I once had a terrible experience with a car mechanic, so all car mechanics are crooks."
7. Example: "The sign said 'fine for parking here,' so since it was fine, I parked there."
8. Example: "You say I shouldn't text while driving, but I've seen you do it many times."
9. Example: "This diet must be effective because a famous celebrity endorses it."
10. Example: "We either ban all plastic bags, or the environment is doomed."
11. Example: "Everyone on social media is using this app, so it must be the best one available."
12. Example: "You should hire me for this job because I have a family to support and no one else is willing to help us."
13. Example: "I've already invested so much time into this project; I can't quit now, even if it's not working."

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14. Example: "This policy is the best because it is better than any other policy."
15. Example: "Every time I wash my car, it rains. My car washing must cause the rain."

WEEK 4 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 15

Poetry

→ INTRO

Have you ever heard of "found poetry"? Learn more with the article below.
∞ Article Link: Found Poetry

→ WRITE

Poets have used historical texts like William Bradford's History of Plimoth Plantation, newspapers, novels, and more to create found poems. The act of rearranging words, pulling words from different places together, and thinking about key images in a text is essentially a way to think more deeply about what you have read. For this assignment, just pick one passage from one of your favorite books as your source text. Use The Count of Monte Cristo if there isn't another book that comes to mind.

- Decide on your selected passage (keep it short - no more than 1-2 pages).
- Highlight words or phrases you particularly like and/or which seem particularly important to the passage.
- Type or write those words on a separate piece of paper and use them to write a poem.
- You may choose whether to limit yourself to ONLY words found in your text or whether you want to add some of your own words as well.

• ANSWER KEY

1. Ad Hominem:
2. Straw Man:
3. Slippery Slope:
4. Red Herring:
5. Appeal to Ignorance:
6. Hasty Generalization:
7. Equivocation:
8. Appeal to Hypocrisy (Tu Quoque):
9. Appeal to Authority:
10. False Dilemma:
11. Bandwagon Fallacy:
12. Appeal to Pity:
13. Sunk Cost Fallacy:
14. Circular Argument:
15. Causal Fallacy:

WEEK 4 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 16

Essay- Current Event

→ WRITE

Current Event: Pick a topic and research. Summarize the perspective of each side in your own words, including brief quotes from each perspective to support your summary. Hyperlink any articles you reference, as in a news article. Aim to give the best points from each perspective, and imagine talking to a person who believed in each. Would they agree that you understand their perspective and have summarized it well?

Focus today on picking your topic and researching different perspectives. Here is a sample outline of how your essay might end up. If time allows, draft the first two paragraphs today. You will have three lesson periods to work on this essay.

- 1 short paragraph introducing the topic you're going to talk about, the key questions people on both sides are trying to answer, and why you think the topic is important.
- 1 paragraph explaining the two main points of view on your topic and the key reasons for each. End this paragraph with your thesis, telling which perspective you're arguing for and your reasons for believing it is right.
- 2-3 paragraphs explaining the two to three arguments that lead you to conclude which perspective is better.
- Concluding paragraph telling your readers why your topic is important to understand and consider. What do you think the cost is for people who have a different perspective or ignore the topic altogether?

• REFERENCE

Current Events

★ STUDENT/TEACHER TIP

The purpose of this essay is to work on researching the conversation about a particular topic, articulating both sides well in your own words, and giving your thoughts. Try to choose a topic that interests you and will be relatively simple to research. For instance, a topic like whether a particular town should add a train line is a better topic for this assignment than something large and complicated to research, such as whether to vote republican, democrat, or third party.

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WEEK 5 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 17

Materials: Steering the Craft

→ PRACTICE Ch.2

- Go back and add punctuation to your writing in Exercise Two from last week. Then, if you still have time, Practice: Being Gorgeous.

WEEK 5 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 18 *Mind Traps*

→ VIEW ∞ Video Link: 21 Mind Traps

→ NARRATE
Sketch, write, or discuss the ideas that you found most interesting from this video. Which mind traps have you fallen into?

- **EXTRA HELPINGS**
If interested, view Mind Traps II listed below today's video.

WEEK 5 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 19 *Essay - Current Events Project Part 2*

→ WRITE
Add to your current events project from Lesson 16. Today, develop your opinion on who has the stronger argument and explain why.

- 2-3 paragraphs explaining the two to three arguments that lead you to conclude which perspective is better.
- Concluding paragraph telling your readers why your topic is important to understand and consider. What do you think the cost is for people who have a different perspective or ignore the topic altogether?

- **REFERENCE**
Current Events

WEEK 5 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 20 *Style*

→ WRITE
Write about something you've read, experienced, or imagined in the style of another author (living or dead). Read your work to someone and see if they can guess the author you're trying to imitate!

- Ideas to think about as you imitate: How formal is your author's style? Do they use colloquialisms or more academic words? How long are their sentences? Do they tend to use passive or active voice? Do they speak directly or in a more roundabout way? Do they use lots of comparisons (metaphors, similes) or tend to approach things more factually?

WEEK 6 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 21

Materials: Steering the Craft

→ READ Ch.3, p.20-32

→ NARRATE
How would you fix the snitty reply sentence? Tell someone about the rhythm of prose and how it keeps the story going.

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Term 1

WEEK 6 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 22

Visual Fallacies

Materials: Advanced Academic Writing II

→ RESEARCH

Ads often feature logical fallacies. Use your lesson time to find 3-5 different ads that explicitly or subtly market a fallacy you studied. Consider the way colors, pictures, and other visual elements of an ad create an argument alongside its words.

WEEK 6 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 23

Tone/voice/style

→ WRITE

Have you noticed that books have a voice? Just as you can recognize a famous singer's voice when you hear a song, authors write in particular ways that establish their tone and voice as writers, which we as readers unconsciously and consciously identify. We easily recognize this when a writer is angry or upset - this tone gets communicated by the words they choose, the number of exclamation marks (or sometimes all CAPS) used, and the way their sentences are structured - often short and punchy!

For the rest of this lesson, rewrite a narration or describe a scene in at least two different ways. Here are a few options, but feel free to come up with others. Label your writing with the tone you intend.

- Casually, as if telling a friend
- In formal/academic English
- As if you are so excited you'll start levitating immediately if you don't tell someone
- As if you are unhappy with the situation

★ STUDENT TIP

Experiment with writing in different authors' styles in your narrations, and pay attention to their tone!

WEEK 6 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 24

Editing- Revise Current Events Project

→ REVISE

Big-Picture Revision

1. Are there other ideas you've had more recently that you'd like to add to your current events essay? Do that now.
2. Are you representing both perspectives fairly and giving the best arguments for each side? Would someone who believes in the other perspective agree that you have summarized and understood them well?
3. Revise your thesis now that you have written the rest of your essay. Is it clear and concise?
4. Does your introduction include the main question and topic you are trying to address in your essay?
5. Look at your paragraphs. Are they indented and focused around one idea each? Describe that main idea in one sentence and consider making that the first sentence of your paragraph.
6. Do your paragraphs flow well? Experiment with moving your key arguments in a different order. Which makes the most sense? It is common to arrange your arguments in the order of weakest to strongest (or vice versa).
7. Does each of your paragraphs support your thesis?

Sentence-Level Revision

1. Did you link to the articles you drew from to learn about different perspectives?
2. Read your paper aloud and fix any grammar errors you hear and see.
3. Use Grammarly or another spell checker to find any other punctuation or spelling issues and fix those.

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4. Give your essay a title (think of it like an article about a news event!)
5. Look for wordiness. Are there any unnecessary words? Do you have any sentences that are very long that you could make into two shorter sentences? Long sentences have their place, but usually, shorter sentences are clearer.
6. Look at your sentences and make sure characters are subjects, and use important action verbs as much as possible.
7. Check for nominalizations! Throw out any unhelpful ones!
8. Make sure your sentences are complete, not fragments.
9. Make sure your essay is consistently in 3rd person while reporting others' perspectives. If desired, you may switch to 1st person when talking about your opinions in the final paragraph(s).

- Turn in your revised paper.

WEEK 7 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 25

Materials: Steering the Craft

→ PRACTICE

Ch.3

Complete Exercise Three, Part One (see the suggested subjects).

WEEK 7 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 26

Types of questions to ask

→ INTRO

Why write questions? Questions engage our brains to think outside our current perspective and wonder about new ideas, connections, and perspectives that might not naturally occur to us. For this reason, almost every writing project you embark on will likely start with questions.

Another benefit of questions is that many books, essays, and other forms of writing (especially non-fiction) essentially exist to answer a question. As you read the news, articles, or other books, ask yourself, "What question does this piece answer?" For instance, a news article often answers the question: "What happened and what should I think about the ____ event?"

→ WRITE

Write 10 questions about a topic or book you're reading for Bible, History, Citizenship, Ourselves, Geography, Architecture, etc.

→ WRITE

Pick 5 non-fiction books or articles you have read this term (fiction can work too, but it is a little trickier) and write down the questions you think are behind the book or article. Explain briefly why you think the book or article is an answer to this question. There may be multiple questions an author is considering, so just pick one you think is significant.

★ TEACHER TIP

If using these lessons in a group, have students share the questions they identified behind a particular book or article. Discuss the way that students may articulate the book's central question differently. The purpose is not to get a "right" answer, but to notice the commonalities and themes that multiple students pick up on, as well as the variety that our perspectives bring to how we read and understand a book.

WEEK 7 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 27

Poetry

→ READ (10 MIN)

Reread John Keats's poem "Ode on a Grecian Urn." Remember that this poem is an example of ekphrasis: the poetic description of a work of art.

∞ Link: Ode on a Grecian Urn

∞ Link: Ekphrasis

→ WRITE

Think of a piece of art you have really loved in Picture Study. With an

• REFERENCE

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12
(Lesson 12)

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image of the art in front of you, start writing your own ekphrastic poem about it. Include any notes about why you chose to write it the way you did. Work to keep your chosen meter/rhyme scheme consistent.

WEEK 7 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 28

Details

→ WRITE

Continue to work on your writing assignment in Geography, where you are combining the 5 versions of the events of a day from the Lewis and Clark expedition into one account indicating what happened to each mentioned member of the expedition. Use 3rd person POV and pay attention to the details you include. Work to help your reader envision the scene by including important sensory details (bonus if you can include details that reference all five senses - sight, sound, taste, touch, and smell)! Write for the whole time.

If you are not taking the Geography course, write a descriptive paragraph inspired by an episode from one of your books this week, taking care to include specific, intentional detail.

• REFERENCE

Geography: Grade 10-11 (Lesson 14)

Book: Five Months on the Missouri River

★ **STUDENT TIP** Remember that small details can lead to big insights. Notice the details an author includes and ponder their significance. For instance, Matthew includes Rahab and Ruth in his genealogy leading up to Jesus's birth (Matthew 1). He usually moves from one to the next, but in a few places, Matthew gives more detail. Why?

WEEK 8 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 29

Materials: Steering the Craft

→ PRACTICE

Ch.3

Complete Exercise Three, Part Two (see the suggested subjects).

WEEK 8 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 30

Plagiarism, source integration, and quotations

Materials: Advanced Academic Writing II

→ INTRO

We do not think in a vacuum. Alan Jacobs even claims that "everything you think is a response to what someone else has thought and said" (How to Think 37). While it is natural to form our own thoughts on what others have said, writers always seek to point back to those sources whenever possible (even as you just saw in the sentence above). When writers tell readers about the people who formed their thoughts, they invite readers into a broader conversation with those authors as well, and they also exhibit humility as they acknowledge their own reliance on others.

→ READ & NARRATE

Have you heard of plagiarism? Plagiarism happens when an author uses someone else's idea without giving them credit. Plagiarism carries heavy consequences in school or academic contexts.

∞ Article Link: Plagiarism

→ ACTIVITY

Different genres of books have different ways of letting authors tell readers where to find their books; they quote or provide information about people or authors they draw on. Pull out several different types of books from your shelves. Where do you see authors citing or acknowledging others? Look in the front pages, in footnotes, in pages at the end, and so on. Look at some online sources as well - a news article, a longer journal article, and a blog. Summarize your findings.

→ INTRO

In academic writing, there are a few different systems for how to reference and give credit to others who have influenced your writing (and

★ STUDENT TIP

You do not need to worry about citations for your normal narrations or personal writing. But we'll start including a few papers and projects over the next several terms, where you'll get a chance to practice more formal citation standards.

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so avoid plagiarism). The APA style, the Chicago Style, and the MLA style are the most common citation systems. Each has different benefits and allows readers quick access to different information about the authors you quote. (For instance, APA is often used in the sciences and allows you to quickly see the date a source was published. Chicago style tends to use a lot of footnotes, which include complete information. MLA (Modern Language Association) is most often used in literature and the humanities, and includes just the author's name and a page number in an essay.

→ READ

You do not have to remember all the little details of where the commas and periods go. Just get a general sense of the citation system, and remember to reference these pages when you are working on your citations in your papers.

Academic Writing II p.10-15 "Works Cited: Review"

→ PRACTICE

Pick three books you are currently reading, and write citations for them (using the Works Cited format given at the bottom of p.10). You'll likely find the information you need on the first page or two of the book. Take your citations to your teacher to review.

WEEK 8 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 31

Finding support for your statements

→ WRITE

What passages in either Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass or Up From Slavery illustrated the importance of education and literacy? Jot down your initial thoughts, then look back at the book and read or skim sections to discover relevant passages or ideas you might have forgotten. Look for both explicit and implicit ways the author makes a point. In other words, look for ways the author conveys ideas through both "showing" and "telling."

• REFERENCE

General Lit 11-12

Book: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass or Up From Slavery, Reflection Questions

WEEK 8 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 32

Revision

→ REVISE

Go back to your descriptive scene from Lesson 28 and revise.

Big-Picture Revision

1. If you didn't type your description before, do that now so you have a digital version to edit.
2. Are there other details you've learned more recently that you'd like to add to your description? Do that now.
3. Look at your paragraphs. Are they indented and focused around one idea each (perhaps you have a paragraph focused just on sight, another on sound, etc., or perhaps you organize your paragraphs spatially and describe the immediate surroundings, the nature, the weather, etc.)? Describe the main focus of the paragraph in one sentence and consider making that the first sentence (topic sentence) of your paragraph.
4. Consider the flow of your description. Try organizing your paragraphs a few different ways and decide what you like best.

Sentence-Level Revision

1. Read your paper aloud and fix any grammar errors you hear and see.
2. Use Grammarly or another spell checker to find any other punctuation or spelling issues and fix those.
3. Give your description a title and put it at the top
4. Delete unnecessary words.
5. Look at each of your sentences (pull them out individually if that helps). Are they complete thoughts and not fragments? Do they have clear

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- characters and actions?
6. Remove any unhelpful nominalizations.
7. For this assignment, make sure your description is consistently in 3rd person.

WEEK 9 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 33

Materials: Steering the Craft

→ READ

Ch.3, p.34

- Compare and contrast the ideas you're reading in Steering the Craft with what you've learned elsewhere.

→ PRACTICE

Check your writings from the last two weeks and see if your paragraphing makes sense. If there is time, practice Being Gorgeous.

WEEK 9 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 34

Ingredients of a good introduction

Materials: Advanced Academic Writing II

→ INTRO

What are the key ingredients of a good introduction in a speech or an essay? Discuss your thoughts orally or in writing.

→ REVIEW

As you refine your writing, let's revisit key ideas on Introductions from Style: The Basics of Clarity and Grace.

- Interest your readers with a provocative first sentence.
- Orient your readers to your topic with important background information
- Include the significance of your topic and the specific question your essay answers.
- End with your solution/main point/claim (your thesis, the answer to your main question).

Refer to Academic Writing II, p.82, for a good example of the first three points in the first paragraph. (You do not get to the author's thesis in the introduction shown because the paper is longer and has an extended introduction.)

→ WRITE

Pick a previous writing project, and revise your introduction (your current events project could work well, but you could also pick a project from last year). It is often easier to see ways to improve your writing when you've given it a little time to rest and can look at it with fresh eyes again. Introductions are often the hardest part of an essay to write because it is not usually until you've fully fleshed out your thoughts in the middle of an essay that you know how to introduce them to your readers.

• EXTRA HELPINGS

Re-read Style: Basics of Clarity and Grace, Lesson 6: "Motivation"

WEEK 9 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 35

Poetry

→ WRITE

Write a narrative poem telling a story from one of your history or geography books.

- Bonus Idea: Try including an epic simile!

• REFERENCE

History or Geography

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WEEK 9 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 36

Plot

→ INTRO

How do authors keep you interested in a story or movie? Name as many ways as you can think of.

→ REFLECT

Reread the opening paragraphs of Ch.9 in *The Count of Monte Cristo*. What are the stages Dantès passes through at the beginning of the chapter? How does the "faint noise" disrupt these stages and give him hope? What questions or expectations does this raise in you, the reader?

Now look at the concluding paragraphs of Ch.9. How does Dumas build the suspense of the novel with the conclusion of the chapter as well?

→ READ & WRITE

Read the article on suspense and look for ways authors hold your interest and move their story forward as you continue reading *The Scarlet Letter* and your other books!

∞ Article Link: Building Suspense

• REFERENCE

General Literature

Book: *The Count of Monte Cristo*

WEEK 10 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 37

Materials: Steering the Craft

→ READ

Ch.4

→ PRACTICE

Complete Exercise Four, Part One.

WEEK 10 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 38

Ingredients of a good conclusion

→ WRITE

What are the key ingredients of a good conclusion in a speech or an essay?

→ REVIEW

From "Style: The Basics of Clarity and Grace," "a good conclusion should bring together your point, its significance, and its implications for thinking further about your problem" (Williams & Bizup 68). One way to organize a conclusion is to:

- Restate your main point/thesis.
- Explain its significance. Pretend a friend reads your essay and says, "So what?" after reading everything up until the conclusion.
- Give any implications or next steps. What other questions does your essay open up? What now?
- End with a memorable last sentence (ideally one that ties back to the opening sentence of your introduction).

→ WRITE

Pick a previous writing project, and revise and refine your conclusion with the list above (your current events project could work well, but you could also pick a project from last year).

• EXTRA HELPINGS

Re-read Style: Basics of Clarity and Grace, Lesson 6: "Motivation" p.68-69.

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WEEK 10 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 39

Dialogue

→ WRITE

Make up two characters (or pick two characters from the same or different books) and write a conversation including dialogue between the two of them. Here are some options:

- Have Rabindranath Tagore talk to Gertrudis Gómez de Avellaneda.
- Write dialogue between Dantès and Mercédès.

→ A NOTE ON DIALOGUE

What makes dialogue move forward? Professor Lowry Pei gives this insight: "When people communicate perfectly, understand each other fully, agree on what must be done – conversation naturally ends. It is the imperfect understanding, the unfinished communication, the disagreement, the mismatch, the unfulfilled wish that keeps a dialogue going....While you're writing what the characters do say, be aware of what they don't say, but are thinking and feeling."

→ REVISE

Save a few minutes at the end of your lesson to quickly revise your work. Make sure to indent dialogue appropriately, read your writing aloud, and see if your dialogue sounds natural. Change it if it doesn't! And pay attention to dialogue in your books as you read!

• DIALOGUE

When writing dialogue, "keep your words and sentences short. Break up the speeches with the other person's questions, gestures, or thoughts. Start a new paragraph whenever the next person speaks, does something, or thinks. Short bursts of speech seem natural to the reader. Just as long speech paragraphs seem unnatural, so do long speech sentences. and so do long words" (from Writing Magic by Gail Levine).

• REFERENCE

Examples given from General Literature and Poetry Reading

WEEK 10 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 40

Revision-poetry

→ REVISE

Pick a poem you've written this term to revise. Revising poetry requires a different process than editing other types of writing. There are so few words in a poem (compared to a whole book or essay) that it makes each word even more important.

1. Type your poem if you haven't already.
2. Revisit the rules of your poem's form (sonnet, sestina, ballad, etc.)
3. Read it aloud.
4. Does your poem follow the rules of its form? (Rhyme, meter, line count, etc.) If you are breaking any of the rules, decide if you are breaking them for a reason to make a point, or if you need to find a different word or phrase to fit the rhyme scheme or meter. (Note: If you choose to break a rule, add a note about why this is important for your poem.)
5. Think about the flow of the ideas and images in your poem. Is there a better way to organize them?
6. Imagery and metaphor are important in nearly all poems. What images and comparisons does your poem use, and are there any others that might capture the image or idea even better?
7. Read your poem aloud again and look for any grammar or spelling errors to fix. Use Grammarly or another spell checker to assist you.
8. Jot down a few of the things you want your reader to walk away thinking or feeling after hearing your poem. Read your poem aloud to someone (or two!) and ask them what their initial impressions are. If they are completely different than what you intended, consider what you might want to alter so that your purpose comes through more clearly.

WEEK 11 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 41

Materials: Steering the Craft

→ READ

Ch.4, p.42

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Term 1

→ NARRATE

Think over the books you are reading; give some examples of repetition, foreshadowing, and echoing (or patterns in the events of life from nonfiction). Tell your teacher what you noticed.

→ PRACTICE

Complete Exercise Four, Part Two.

WEEK 11 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 42

MLA Paper Formatting

Materials: Advanced Academic Writing II

→ RECAP

What are citation systems? What is plagiarism? How do you avoid it? Discuss your answers orally or in writing.

→ INTRO

The MLA style of citation gives more guidelines on how to cite an author you are quoting. MLA, Chicago, and other citation systems also standardize how a paper looks. This is important because if a teacher tells students to write a two-page paper, and one student turns in a paper in 8pt font and another student makes their font size 14, the length of those two papers is quite different. You will continue to learn the MLA way to format papers, but know that different teachers have slightly different standards, and you will want to ask professors for their preferred style and guidelines in any classes you take.

→ READ

Advanced Academic Writing II p.8-9

→ PRACTICE

Pick a narration or previous writing project and work on formatting it according to the MLA guidelines outlined in Advanced Academic Writing II. (Choose a narration based on a book, rather than a current events reflection, as books are much easier to cite.) Additionally, papers are usually required to be in Times New Roman font size 12, so turn your paper to that font and size as well.

→ REVIEW (IF NEEDED)

Academic Writing II p.10-15 "Works Cited: Review"

→ NOTE

Microsoft Word is the best program for formatting papers, but other programs are also possible. If you do not know how to adjust the spacing in your program, look up how to do it online. For instance, you might Google "how to adjust spacing in Microsoft Word." Also, you may notice in the Works Cited examples on p.9 that the second line of a citation is indented. These are called hanging indents, and they are used exclusively in Bibliographies and Works Cited entries.

∞ Link: Hanging Indent

WEEK 11 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 43

Technology

→ CREATE/ WRITE

Technology and writing are so intertwined nowadays. Experiment with the two by picking one of the options below:

- Design a poster inspired by something you read.
- Write a narration in the style of a blog post.
- Create a website about something you read about recently (see the extra helpings page for a Wix resource).

• EXTRA HELPINGS

Resource for students interested in web design.

∞ Resource Link: Wix for Tomorrow

Composition: Grade 11

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Term 1	
• Make a PowerPoint/ Google Slides to accompany a narration you wrote, and give a presentation using your PowerPoint/Google Slides to friends or family. → REVIEW (OPTIONAL) ∞ Article Link: Rules for PowerPoints	
WEEK 11 📅 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 44 <i>Catch-Up Day</i> → CATCH UP Use this time to catch up on writing assignments that you haven't had a chance to finish in this course.	
WEEK 12 📅 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 45 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: Steering the Craft	
WEEK 12 📅 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 46 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: Composition Lessons	
WEEK 12 📅 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 47 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: Composition Lessons	
WEEK 12 📅 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 48 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: Composition Lessons	

Composition: Grade 11

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Term 2

WEEK 1 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 49 Materials: Steering the Craft → READ Read through the whole chapter, exercise, and critique inclusively. Ch.5 → PRACTICE Complete Exercise 5.	★ TEACHER/STUDENT NOTE Note that Chapter 5 discusses instances of language in fictional writing.
WEEK 1 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 50 Reflection → WRITE Write down questions you have about writing. Where do you think you have improved? Where do you think you need to grow? What about writing is the most fun, most confusing, easiest, or hardest? Discuss with your teacher.	
WEEK 1 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 51 Essay → WRITE Write about a current event (it could be a very local one, like the weather in your town) as though you are a reporter for a newspaper. Show your sources by linking to other articles you've read as you refer to them in your piece. Think back to your question-asking assignment. What is the central question you want to answer in your article? Include this question somewhere in your piece (consider even using it as a title).	● REFERENCE Current Events
WEEK 1 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 52 Materials: Advanced Academic Writing II Editing → REVISE Take your current event report from Lesson 51 and revise it. Work in this order: 1. Global revisions (structure, transitions, content to add or change) 2. Sentence-level revisions 3. Formatting revisions For this project, follow these formatting guidelines (adapted from Advanced Academic Writing II, p.8-9- See sample paper on p.9 for a visual) ● Set your font to Times New Roman, size 12. ● Set a one-inch margin on all four sides. ● Set all text to double-spaced. ● Indent all paragraphs. ● Left-justify the text (usually the default). ● Put your name, your teacher's name, the course name (Composition: Grade 11), and the date on separate lines at the beginning of your paper. ● Center the title of your paper (come up with one if you haven't yet). ● Instead of in-text citations, link to the article you are referencing directly in your paper.	★ STUDENT NOTE Depending on whether you like details, revision lessons are probably either your favorite or least favorite type of writing lesson. This is 100% normal. Most writers like some aspects of writing more (or less) than others. For instance, some famous authors, including Jane Austen, Albert Einstein, and Winston Churchill, struggled with spelling and grammar!

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Term 2

WEEK 2 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 53

Materials: Steering the Craft

→ **RE-READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**
Ch.5

- Tell your teacher about the exercise from last week and what you learned about the sparing use of adjectives and adverbs. How did leaving them out improve your use of verbs?

→ **PRACTICE**
Repeat Exercise 5.

★ STUDENT TIP

Continue to exercise your skills from last term. Pay attention to logical fallacies you see or read.

WEEK 2 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 54

Story

→ **WRITE**

Tell a story using some of the techniques you've learned in Steering the Craft. You can make up a story, tell a story about an experience you had, or retell a story from one of your books.

WEEK 2 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 55

Outline

→ **WRITE**

Continue outlining Thoreau's essay from History of Literature.

• REFERENCE

History of Lit (Lesson 14)

WEEK 2 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 56

Questions

→ **INTRO**

You know good questions are important for all kinds of growth. Here are some questions that are particularly interesting to think about when pondering narrative-type books:

Themes & Characters

- What are the central ideas of the book? How are they developed throughout?
- What insights into human nature does the book offer? What is the book and the author's vision of a "good" life?
- Who are the main characters, and how do they change over the story? What are their motivations?
- How do the characters interact with each other? How do their relationships develop?

Structure & Literary Connections

- What is the narrative structure of the book? What is its genre? Is the story told chronologically, or does it use flashbacks or multiple timelines? What are the major conflicts in the book? Are they resolved?
- What literary devices does the author use? How do metaphors, similes, and other figures of speech show up in the narrative? Are there any notable uses of symbolism or irony?
- What is the author's writing style? How does the choice of language, tone, and narrative voice contribute to the book's overall impact?
- What is the point of view of the narrative? How does the point of view influence the reader's perception of the story? Does the narrator's perspective color the events in a particular way?
- What is the significance of the book's title?

Setting, Reception & History

- How does the book's setting influence the story?

★ STUDENT TIP

As you read this week, don't forget to notice details. How does each author immerse you in a place or situation?

With extra time, copy 4-8 questions from the list that you particularly want to remember.

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- What historical, social, or cultural contexts are important to understanding the book? How does the author respond to or reflect on these contexts?
- What was the original audience for the book? What was the book's impact on its readers? How have different audiences or critics interpreted the book? Has the book's reception changed over time?

Personal Impact

- How did the book affect you personally? Did you relate to any of the characters or situations? How did it change your perspective or understanding of the world?
- What lingering questions do you have after finishing the book? Are there any ambiguities or unresolved issues that provoke further thought?
- What other books or ideas connect to this one?

→ WRITE

Pick a book from last term or this one (a narrative, not non-fiction), pick a few of the questions above that you find most interesting, and write your thoughts. Look back at the book, write down more questions that come to mind, and continue jotting down your thoughts.

WEEK 3 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 57

Materials: Steering the Craft

→ READ

Ch.6, p.47-54

→ WRITE

Think over (or check if needed) the person of the verb and the tense of the verb for some of your readings this term. Try to find different examples and make a list of the books with the person & tense used.

WEEK 3 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 58

Technology

→ CREATE

Design a bookmark to remind you of questions to keep in mind as you read (choose a few from Lesson 52 or others you come up with yourself).

- Feel free to first sketch a design by hand. Then use Canva or another design software to finish and print your bookmarks.

WEEK 3 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 59

Revision

→ REVISE

Pick a previous narration that is at least two paragraphs long to revise and rewrite.

Big-Picture Revision

1. If you have not already typed your narration, do that now so you have a digital version to edit.
2. Are there other ideas you've had more recently that you'd like to add to your narration? Do that now.
3. Look at your paragraphs. Are they indented and focused around one idea each? Describe that main idea in one sentence and consider making that the first sentence of your paragraph.
4. Try moving your paragraphs around in a different order. What order do you think might make the most sense to someone reading your words?

Sentence-Level Revision

★ STUDENT TIP

Remember the way that an essay or even just an individual paragraph is also an answer to a question. When you identify one larger question, the answer to that question becomes your thesis. Then, smaller questions that help you answer the larger question can become the focus of each paragraph of an essay.

Whenever you are working to revise your writing and organize your thoughts, particularly if it is in an essay format, ask yourself, "What questions am I answering in this paragraph?" "What is the main question my whole essay or article is answering?"

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Term 2

1. Read your narration aloud and fix any grammar or spelling errors you hear or see.
2. Use Grammarly or another spell checker to find any other punctuation or spelling issues and fix those.
3. Look for wordiness. Are there any unnecessary words? Do you have any sentences that are very long that you could make into two shorter sentences? Long sentences have their place, but usually, shorter sentences are clearer.
4. Make the main characters the subjects of sentences.
5. Make important action verbs.
6. How well do your sentences flow? Put old information before new information in your sentences.

- Share your revised narration with someone.

WEEK 3 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 60

Tone/Imitation

→ WRITE

Have you noticed any mannerisms in the authors you've read this year (in school or on your own time)? Try writing (or re-writing) a narration the way one of your favorite authors would. When you're done, read your narration aloud to someone else and see if they can guess the author you're imitating!

OR

Write a 2-3 page manual of your own (following Christians Reading Classics).

• REFERENCE

Ancient History (Lesson 29)

WEEK 4 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 61

Materials: Steering the Craft

→ READ

Ch.6, p.54-58

→ PRACTICE

Complete Exercise 6, Version 1.

WEEK 4 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 62

Literature Connection & Composition

→ READ

W.E.B Du Bois (who you might have read more about in Literature lessons) wrote a parody of My Country 'Tis of Thee. Read his poem and the original lyrics.

∞ Link: My Country 'Tis of Thee by W.E.B. Du Bois

∞ Video Link: My Country 'Tis of Thee

→ WRITE

Write a paragraph explaining how W.E.B. Du Bois's poem critiques the original.

OR

Compare W.E.B. Du Bois's poem to Frederick Douglass's "What to the Slave is the Fourth of July?" speech.

∞ Link: What to the Slave Is the 4th of July?

• REFERENCE

Folk Songs (Lesson 15)
General Literature

WEEK 4 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 63

Poetry

→ WRITE

Write or rewrite a narration as a poem.

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WEEK 4 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 64

Technology-PowerPoint/Google Slides

→ VIEW, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Video Link: Data Visualization

→ CREATE

Keep the ideas from the lecture you heard in mind, and begin creating a PowerPoint using one of the options below. You'll have another lesson to revise and finish your work.

- Three favorite things you've learned so far this year (and why they're your favorite)
- Why [Book] is your favorite
- How a science lab you did worked/the process of the lab, and the results
- Introduce 3 significant historical characters or events all happening at the same time in the world
- A different way to visualize some data based on the lecture you heard

Have fun experimenting!

WEEK 5 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 65

📖 Materials: Steering the Craft

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.6

→ PRACTICE

Complete Exercise 6, Version 2

WEEK 5 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 66

Travel Writing

→ WRITE

Think back on some travels (short or long, near or far) that you took and write your own travel account. Think about the descriptions you include. Can you make your account vivid and memorable for your readers?

WEEK 5 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 67

Editing

→ REVISE

Work on revising your PowerPoint from Lesson 64. Check for spelling, add any new ideas, revisit the rules for PowerPoint, etc.

→ PRESENT

Plan a time to talk through your presentation with a live audience.

WEEK 5 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 68

Catch-Up Day

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on writing assignments that you haven't had a chance to finish in this course.

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WEEK 6 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 69

Materials: Steering the Craft

→ READ

Ch.7, p.61-69

→ PRACTICE

Complete the "Further Reading" activity.

WEEK 6 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 70

Essay-genre analysis

Materials: Advanced Academic Writing II

→ READ

Dating back to Aristotle, many authors and playwrights visualize the shape of a story or play in five parts. Read about or review this 5-part structure, then think (and look) back over what you've read in *The Tempest*. Does the play follow this general arc? Where would you identify the introduction, rising action, and climax? Explain.

∞ Article Link: Five-Act Structure

∞ Article Link: Five-Act Opt. 2

→ WRITE

For today, write your initial thoughts on the question above and where you see the various aspects of a five-act structure in *The Tempest*. Then go to the actual play and re-read relevant scenes. Look for lines that demonstrate this arc (or push back against the idea) and collect them in a document (make sure to gather the references for them as well - see Academic Writing II p.72-73 for examples of how to cite Shakespeare).

• REFERENCE

Plays/Shakespeare (Term 1)

Book: *The Tempest*

WEEK 6 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 71

Essay - Shakespeare

→ WRITE

Remember when you learned that many pieces of writing are focused on a question? Notice how your entire piece today is focused on the question, "Is the play following the general 5-part structure arc of a play?" That is your large question. Then notice the smaller questions that will help you answer that larger one: Where do you identify the introduction, rising action, and climax? You'll have another lesson time to work on this essay. There are many ways you could proceed, but here is one possibility (a classic five-paragraph essay):

- Introduction: Introduce the main question and write your answer in one sentence (your thesis).
- Paragraph: Where/do you see the standard features of an "introduction" in *The Tempest*?
- Paragraph: Where/do you see the standard features of "rising action"?
- Paragraph: Where/do you see the standard features of a "climax"?
- Conclusion: Summarize your main points and give any additional thoughts about how the assignment helped you understand the play better, any additional questions you have, etc.

Your final essay should be about 2 pages long (double-spaced in 12-point Times New Roman font), which means you'll want to write 2-3 body paragraphs proving your thesis, along with an introduction and a conclusion.

Spend the time today drafting your thesis and gathering the evidence you

• REFERENCE

Plays/Shakespeare (Term 1)

Book: *The Tempest*



Term 2

gathered in the last lesson into paragraphs and an argument. Remember that you'll have another lesson to revise and finish your essay.	
WEEK 6 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 72 <i>Poetry/Scene</i> → WRITE Try writing a poem about one of your readings (or rewrite a narration) in Short Meter (four-line stanzas with a 6-6-8-6 syllable pattern). This is a common meter for hymns, and a favorite one of Emily Dickinson (See "A Bird came down the Walk"). OR Write a scene for a play or tell it in graphic novel/comic style.	• REFERENCE History of Literature (Lesson 17) Emily Dickinson
WEEK 7 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 73 Materials: Steering the Craft → READ Ch.7, p.70-71 → PRACTICE Complete Exercise 7, Part 1.	
WEEK 7 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 74 <i>Poetry - Comparison</i> → REVIEW What do you remember about found poetry? → WRITE Create a found poem out of at least two different sources today. You could use two closely related sources, or you could pick two sources that contrast in some way. • Choose your two different specific passages (keep them short). • Brainstorm why you think each source is interesting. • Jot down similarities and differences between them. • Jot down any new thoughts or questions you have because of the comparison. • Highlight words or phrases in each of your selections that you like and that seem important to the passages. • Put those words and phrases into a separate document or sheet of paper. • Start building your poem. Here you will have to decide the form and direction of your poem. You could write a stanza of your poem using one source and then a second using the other source, and then conclude it with a third stanza reflecting poetically on their similarities or differences and the new questions you have by putting them together. The main question to ask yourself is: "Why is it interesting to consider these two different sources together in the same poem?" Maybe they highlight the variety of things composed during the same time period. Or the way that people's experiences have similarities across time and space. Maybe they just raise questions for you. • Keep writing your poem until the end of the lesson. You can use a revision lesson later in the term (or spend your own time) to refine your poem further if interested.	

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WEEK 7 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 75

Revision

Materials: Advanced Academic Writing II

→ REVISE

Now that your Shakespeare paper (Lesson 70-71) has rested, revise it with fresh eyes.

Work through the following levels of revision. Look back at previous revision lessons if you need to review specific steps for each of the first two levels of revision.

1. Global revisions (structure, transitions, content to add or change)
2. Sentence-level revisions
3. Formatting revisions

For this project, follow these formatting guidelines (adapted from Advanced Academic Writing II, p.8-9- see the sample paper on p.9 for a visual)

- Set your font to Times New Roman, size 12.
- Set a one-inch margin on all four sides.
- Set all text to double-spaced.
- Indent all paragraphs.
- Left-justify the text (usually the default).
- Put your name, your teacher's name, the course name (Composition: Grade 11), and the date on separate lines at the beginning of your paper.
- Center the title of your paper (come up with one if you haven't yet).
- See Academic Writing II p.72-73, for examples of how to cite Shakespeare.

WEEK 7 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 76

Scene Writing/Dialogue

→ INTRO

It's hard to get dialogue in a book to sound natural. Read these thoughts on writing dialogue.

∞ Article Link: Thoughts on Dialogue (stop at "other than stage direction.")

→ WRITE

Write a scene for a play from The Count of Monte Cristo, Jane Eyre or James, a Bible passage, or another reading. Don't forget the instructions for the stage setup and any props! Feel free to look back at a Shakespeare play to remind yourself how to format/write a scene.

• REFERENCE

Ancient History: Grades 10-12
Church History: Grades 10-12
Geography: Grades 10-11
Bible

WEEK 8 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 77

Materials: Steering the Craft

→ READ

Ch.7

→ PRACTICE

Complete Exercise 7, Part 2.

WEEK 8 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 78

Questions

→ WRITE

Pick a non-fiction book and a fiction book from this term, and write at

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least 10 questions about each. Think about the way different books lend themselves to different questions.

→ REVISE

With any extra time, pick a narration from the last week or two to edit and revise.

WEEK 8 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 79

Poetic Meditation

→ RESEARCH & WRITE

Over the next two lessons, you'll create a poetic paraphrase and meditation on a psalm.

Today:

- Pick a psalm that you either love or don't know much about and want to know better.
- Read it in at least 3 different translations (and if you're learning another language, try reading the psalm in that language as well).
- Underline phrases or words that strike you, images you notice, connections to other psalms or passages, etc.
- Decide on a poetic form (such as a sonnet) and/or rhyme/meter you'd like to use (you can change this later if desired).
- Practice writing a few lines in the meter you're hoping to use.
- Start writing your paraphrase and meditation on your psalm.

→ NOTE

Aim to choose a psalm that is somewhere between 10-30 verses. Or you could try two shorter psalms. You could also just pick a few stanzas of a longer psalm, like Psalm 119. (An idea: You could paraphrase a few stanzas of Psalm 119 and keep its acrostic pattern!)

WEEK 8 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 80

Poetic Meditation

→ WRITE & REVISE

- Continue your poetic paraphrase and meditation on your chosen psalm. When you are finished, look back over your poem.
- Read it aloud and circle or underline any words or phrases that don't flow or sound quite right. Revise.
- Share your poem with someone else and ask for feedback.
- If you have time left in the lesson (or on your own time), consider any illustrations you might want to add.

WEEK 9 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 81

Materials: Steering the Craft

→ READ

Ch.7

→ PRACTICE

Complete Exercise 7, Part 3.

WEEK 9 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 82

Compare/Contrast

→ WRITE

Write a well-organized paragraph or two comparing The Aeneid's opening Invocation to the Muse (lines 1-13) to the openings of The Iliad and The Odyssey.

∞ PDF Link: Iliad Opening Lines

• REFERENCE

Poetry Reading 11-12 (Lesson 37)

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∞ PDF Link: Odyssey Opening Lines

- How is Virgil both imitating Homer and also doing something very new?

WEEK 9 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 83

Compare/Contrast or Dialogue

→ WRITE

Continue adding to your thoughts from the last lesson.

OR

Write a dialogue or scene between two characters from different books.

WEEK 9 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 84

Editing

→ REVISE

Revise your found poem from two sources (Lesson 74) or another poem from this term.

1. Revisit the rules of the form you're using (if applicable).
2. Read your poem aloud. Are there any grammar or spelling errors to fix?
3. Does your poem follow the rules of its form? (Rhyme, meter, etc.) If you are breaking any of the rules, decide if you are breaking them for a reason to make a point, or if you need to work on finding a different word to fit the rhyme scheme or meter.
4. Re-read the works your poem is based on. Is there anything you didn't get into the poem the first time that you want to add? Delete?
5. Think about the flow of the ideas and images in your poem. Is there a better way to organize them? Does your poem have a logical flow?
6. Imagery and metaphor are important in nearly all poems. What images and comparisons does your poem use, and are there any others that might capture an image or idea even more vividly? Think of at least two other images or comparisons you could use and try them out. Decide which is best and keep that.
7. Jot down a few things you want your reader to walk away thinking or feeling after hearing your poem. Read your poem aloud to someone (or two!) and ask them what their initial impressions are. If they are completely different than what you intended, consider what you might want to alter so that your purpose comes through more clearly.

WEEK 10 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 85

📖 Materials: Steering the Craft

→ READ

Ch.7

→ PRACTICE

Complete Exercise 7, Part 4.

WEEK 10 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 86

Diagram/Infographic

→ CREATE

Sketch or create a diagram online showing the process of something from beginning to end. You could illustrate a science lab, how to bake cookies, or anything else. Think about how to communicate your flow of ideas visually.

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WEEK 10 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 87

Compare & Contrast

→ WRITE

Pick two or three different aspects to compare and contrast in a few of these different worlds: Roman World, British North America, Indigenous North America, 19th century Europe, or Civil War-era America. You will have three lessons total to work on your comparison and contrast.

Today, spend time brainstorming some contrasts you want to focus on. Write down any ideas that immediately come to mind, then look back at your books, take notes, write down quotes, and enjoy researching!

Remember that "research" literally means "re-search," as in "search again." Don't just settle for the initial impressions that come to your mind - go look for more contrasts and comparisons, and look for specific quotes to back up and use as evidence for the ideas you have at first (or quotes which challenge your ideas!).

Ideas for possible contrasts:

\- Economics, political structure, view of writing, family customs, religion, etc.

• REFERENCE

History Topics

WEEK 10 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 88

Materials: Advanced Academic Writing II

Compare & Contrast

→ WRITE

Continue your compare and contrast project from the last lesson. Focus on pulling your ideas together and writing today. Your paper should be 2-3 pages long (double-spaced in Times New Roman font 12), so you'll probably want to have at least 3 body paragraphs.

Everyone has to find their own process for writing, but often it is best to draft your thesis, write your main body paragraphs showing your comparisons and contrasts, and then finish by writing your introduction and conclusion.

If you get stuck writing, take a break for a few minutes and look up the information you'll need for your Works Cited page. Refer to p.10ff. in Advanced Academic Writing II, for examples of a Works Cited entry. Remember: you'll need works cited entries for all books you either quote or paraphrase.

• REFERENCE

Ancient History: Grades 10-12 + all history topics.

WEEK 11 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 89

Materials: Steering the Craft

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.7, p.73-86

WEEK 11 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 90

→ WRITE

Write or rewrite a narration and work to incorporate some of the things you've learned from Steering the Craft this term. At the end of your writing assignment, give a few sentences explaining which ideas from Steering the Craft you incorporated and where.

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WEEK 11 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 91

Catch Up Day

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on lessons in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.

WEEK 11 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 92

Revision

 Materials: Advanced Academic Writing II

→ REVISE

As you revise your comparison and contrast paper from Lessons 87-88, envision someone reading your paper who is somewhat familiar with your topic but hasn't read your books. Try to see your paper through their eyes, and think of what they might need to know to understand what you've written. For some, this revision process is their favorite part, and you love making your paper look sleek and smooth. For others, it seems tedious. Either way, remember that this is a way to be kind to your reader and to stretch yourself.

Big-Picture/Global Revision

1. Are there other ideas you've had more recently that you'd like to add to your current events essay? Do that now.
2. Revise your thesis now that you have written the rest of your essay. Is it clear and concise?
3. Does your introduction include the main question and topic you are trying to address in your essay?
4. Look at your paragraphs. Are they indented and focused around one idea each? Describe that main idea in one sentence and consider making that the first sentence of your paragraph.
5. Do your paragraphs flow well? Experiment with moving your key comparisons/contrasts in a different order. Which makes the most sense?
6. Does each of your paragraphs tie back to your thesis?

Sentence-Level Revision

1. Read your paper aloud and fix any grammar errors you hear and see.
2. Use Grammarly or another spell checker to find any other punctuation or spelling issues and fix those.
3. Give your essay a title.
4. Make the main characters the subjects of sentences and use important action verbs where possible.
5. How well do your sentences flow? Put old information before new information in your sentences.
6. Delete unnecessary words and change negatives to affirmatives.
7. Make sure your sentences are complete, not fragments.
8. Make sure your essay is consistently in 3rd person.

Formatting Revisions

1. For this project, follow the formatting guidelines in Advanced Academic Writing II p.8-9.
2. Set your font to Times New Roman, size 12.
3. Be sure to add your Works Cited page as a separate page after your essay, and format it with hanging indents. Remember, you can look up anything online if you've forgotten how to double-space your paper, etc.

→ REFERENCE

Advanced Academic Writing II p.16-39, includes some helpful information on common grammar and usage mistakes.

• CONCISION NOTE

Remember the 6 rules of

Concision from Style: Basics of Clarity and Grace:

1. Delete words that mean little or nothing.
2. Delete words that repeat the meaning of other words.
3. Delete words implied by other words.
4. Replace a phrase with a word.
5. Change negatives to affirmatives.
6. Delete useless adjectives and adverbs.

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WEEK 12 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 93 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: Steering the Craft	
WEEK 12 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 94 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: Composition Lessons	
WEEK 12 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 95 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: Composition Lessons	
WEEK 12 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 96 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: Composition Lessons	

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Term 3

WEEK 1 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 97

Materials: Steering the Craft

→ PRACTICE

Ch.7 p.75

Complete Exercise 7 (NOT) Optional Additions; choose one.

WEEK 1 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 98

Materials: Communicating with Grace and Virtue

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Introduction

WEEK 1 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 99

→ WRITE

Pick one or two specific passages or verses from your Bible reading in the gospels. Look up the same passage in at least three different translations of the Bible. Then write an essay comparing and contrasting the different translations. Explain the different imagery and how the emphases come out differently. Biblegateway.com is a good online resource to use to compare translations if you do not have three different physical translations in your house.

• REFERENCE

New Testament

Book: NIV Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, any other translations you like!

WEEK 1 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 100

Poetic Language

→ WRITE

Try writing several of your own epic similes. You can use prose or verse - try to do at least one of each. If you're stumped with where to start, try comparison a universal human experience (positive or negative) with something from nature.

WEEK 2 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 101

Materials: Steering the Craft

→ PRACTICE

Ch.1, p.8

Practice Being Gorgeous.

WEEK 2 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 102

Materials: Communicating with Grace and Virtue

→ NOTE

Each chapter has several sidebars and text boxes with extra material relevant to the topic, but they should be read after each section. Read the main text first, then skim back over the extra information to see if you want to read it.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.1

WEEK 2 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 103

Scene Writing

→ WRITE

Write a section from Things Fall Apart, The Celebrated Jumping Frog of Calaveras County, The Gift of the Magi, The Aeneid, or another book of your choice as a short play. You'll have two lesson periods to focus on this.

• REFERENCE

General Lit (Term 3) All books and short stories

Poetry Reading (Term 3) Book: The Aeneid



Term 3

Today, focus on sketching out the big picture. How many scenes will you include? (Remember, scenes can be short.) What will you focus on in each scene? What extra characters will you invent? Look at one of Shakespeare's plays or another play you've read to remind yourself how to format your writing.

Once you have a general idea of how you want your play to go (of course, you'll tweak things as you go), start writing!

Here is one example of how someone else turned part of *Pride & Prejudice* into a play.
∞ PDF Link: [Scenes by Pertwee](#)

WEEK 2 **40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 104**
Editing

→ WRITE & REVISE

Continue writing your play. Save at least 10 minutes at the end to review and edit.

1. Check punctuation, grammar, and spelling with your own eyes and a spell checker.
2. Read your dialogue aloud and revise. Does it sound natural? Remember that we tend to speak in shorter sentences and fragments.
3. Add instructions for props as desired.
4. Make sure you indicate the setting for each scene (i.e., the front yard of a house, a boat, etc.)
5. Write a summary of each scene (if you have multiple), describing what happens in it.
6. Make a plan to have some friends perform your play!

WEEK 3 **40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 105**
Materials: Steering the Craft

→ READ
Ch.8

→ PRACTICE
Complete Exercise 8, Part 1.

WEEK 3 **40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 106**
Materials: Communicating with Grace and Virtue

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS
Ch.2

WEEK 3 **40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 107**
Style

→ WRITE
Write or rewrite a narration as a poem, play, or 1st person narrative.

WEEK 3 **40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 108**
Technology/visual

→ CREATE
Make a poster, infographic, mind map, or any other sort of visual from your reading that you'd like to see another way. Use one of the ideas below or come up with your own. Draw or model it in 3-D by hand if desired first, and if there is time left, try creating it with Canva.

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	• Events in Jesus' life from your reading in the gospels • Character map from Things Fall Apart, Shakespeare, or another reading • Something from Science • Connections between different books you've read this year • Structure of an Epistle from the Bible • Something from History or Geography	
WEEK 4	40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 109 Materials: Steering the Craft → READ Ch.8, p.90-93 → PRACTICE Complete Exercise 8, Part 2.	
WEEK 4	40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 110 Materials: Communicating with Grace and Virtue → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.3	
WEEK 4	40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 111 Brainstorm Imagine you are going to write a research paper on the Pig War. Where do you start? With a brainstorm of possible topics, questions, and ideas. ∞ Article Link: Pig War Research Project	REFERENCE Folk Songs (Lesson 28)
WEEK 4	40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 112 Style → WRITE Write about something you've read, experienced, or imagined in the style of another author (living or dead). Read your work to someone and see if they can guess the author you're trying to imitate!	• REFERENCE History
WEEK 5	40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 113 Materials: Steering the Craft → READ Ch.9, p.94-100 → PRACTICE Complete Exercise 9, Part 1.	
WEEK 5	40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 114 Materials: Communicating with Grace and Virtue → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.4	
WEEK 5	40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 115 Newspaper Article → WRITE Create a newspaper article about one of the entertainers or sports you've	• REFERENCE U.S. History 9-12 (Lesson 55) Book: US History: Volume 2

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read about in American History: Volume 2.

OR

Create a newspaper article about another event you have read about recently in another History course.

WEEK 5 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 116

Outline

→ WRITE

Outline a couple of the chapters you have read so far in one of your Church History or Citizenship readings. Remember, an outline is just a list of the key points from each chapter. It is often done in a bullet-point format.

• REFERENCE

Church History

OR

Citizenship

WEEK 6 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 117

Materials: Steering the Craft

→ READ

Ch.9, p.100-111

→ PRACTICE

Complete Exercise 9, Part 2.

WEEK 6 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 118

Materials: Communicating with Grace and Virtue

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.5 (1/2)

WEEK 6 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 119

Editing

→ REVISE

Pick a previous narration that is at least two paragraphs long to revise and rewrite. Follow your typical process and work through big-picture revisions and sentence-level revisions.

Then format your narration in MLA format.

Share your revised narration with someone.

WEEK 6 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 120

PowerPoint/ Google Slides OR Poetry

→ CREATE

Make a PowerPoint to accompany a previous narration or writing assignment.

OR

Write or rewrite a narration as a poem.

→ SHARE

Share your work with someone!

★ STUDENT TIP

Don't forget!

∞ **Article Link:** Rules for Powerpoints

WEEK 7 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 121

Materials: Steering the Craft

→ READ

Ch.9

Composition: Grade 11

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	→ PRACTICE Complete Exercise Nine, Part 3.	
WEEK 7	📅 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 122 📖 Materials: Communicating with Grace and Virtue → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.5 (1/2)	
WEEK 7	📅 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 123 <i>Literary Analysis</i> → WRITE Pick a commonplace book quote and describe why you like it. Then write at least 10 questions about the quote and how it relates to the book it's from, other books you've read, the historical setting, wider themes in the book, or more.	
WEEK 7	📅 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 124 <i>Catch-Up Day</i> → CATCH UP Use this time to catch up on writing assignments that you haven't had a chance to finish in this course.	
WEEK 8	📅 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 125 📖 Materials: Steering the Craft → READ Ch.9, p.113-116 → PRACTICE Complete Exercise 9, (NOT) Optional Exercises; choose one.	
WEEK 8	📅 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 126 📖 Materials: Communicating with Grace and Virtue → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.6 (1/2)	
WEEK 8	📅 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 127 <i>Essay - Characterization</i> → WRITE Do you think Aeneas is in charge of his own actions, or is he being controlled by fate and the gods? Give reasons from your reading and cite line numbers.	• REFERENCE Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 (Lesson 64)
WEEK 8	📅 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 128 <i>Choosing a Topic</i> → RESEARCH Look back over several of your writing assignments, questions you've generated, or narrations for the term, and pick one you'd like to expand into an essay. Your essay will be about 2-3 pages long, like the others you've written.	

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To choose a topic, ask yourself, "What question am I interested in exploring more?" and "What question can I answer in a few paragraphs?" You could pick a commonplace book reflection, your reflection on reason and will, your character sketch of Hal or Odysseus, or something from your science readings and lab work, etc. After you think you have an idea of what you'd like to write about, look back at your books to jot down specific ideas you might want to include, relevant quotes, etc. Make sure you end up with a specific question you want to answer in your essay. This is your guiding star.	
WEEK 9	40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 129 Materials: Steering the Craft → PRACTICE Choose an exercise from any previous chapters to repeat.
WEEK 9	40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 130 Materials: Communicating with Grace and Virtue → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.6 (1/2)
WEEK 9	40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 131 Essay → WRITE Continue writing the essay that you started in Lesson 128.
WEEK 9	40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 132 Editing → WRITE & REVISE Continue writing your essay (from Lessons 128 and 131), and spend time revising it. Work through big picture, sentence-level, and formatting revisions. Be sure to format your paper according to MLA guidelines, and don't forget a Works Cited page!
WEEK 10	40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 133 Materials: Steering the Craft → READ Ch.10 → PRACTICE Complete Exercise 10.
WEEK 10	40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 134 Materials: Communicating with Grace and Virtue → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.7

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WEEK 10 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 135

Reflection

→ WRITE

Write down questions you have about writing. Where do you think you have improved? Where do you think you need to grow? What about writing is the most fun, most confusing, easiest, and hardest?

Discuss with your teacher.

WEEK 10 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 136

Questions/POV

→ WRITE

Write as many questions as you can during the time about one or a few different books (and/or the connections between them). Then circle the ones that you're particularly curious about.

OR

Retell a scene from Things Fall Apart from a 1st person POV.

WEEK 11 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 137

Materials: Steering the Craft

→ READ & NARRATE

Appendix

- Consider setting up a peer group if you are interested. How might a writing group be helpful in a writer's association or a college setting?

→ PRACTICE

Ch.10

Repeat Exercise 10.

WEEK 11 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 138

Materials: Communicating with Grace and Virtue

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.8

WEEK 11 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 139

Essay - Character

→ WRITE

What do you think makes a true hero according to Virgil? Do you agree with him?

OR

Write a character sketch of Aeneas or Okonkwo from Things Fall Apart. What is he like? What are his chief characteristics?

• REFERENCE

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12
(Term 3)

General Literature: Grades 11-12
(Term 3)

WEEK 11 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 140

Revision

Materials: Advanced Academic Writing II

→ REVISE

Revise and edit your character sketch of Odysseus from the last lesson.

Big-Picture Revision

1. Are there other ideas you've had more recently that you'd like to add to your narration? Do that now.



Term 3

- 2. Look at your paragraphs. Are they indented and focused around one idea each? Describe that main idea in one sentence and consider making that the first sentence of your paragraph.
- 3. Try moving your paragraphs around in a different order. What order do you think might make the most sense to someone reading your words?
- 4. Consider formatting your character sketch as an essay with an intro, body, and conclusion (not required).

Sentence-Level Revision

- 1. Read your narration aloud and fix any grammar or spelling errors you hear or see.
- 2. Use Grammarly or another spell checker to find any other punctuation or spelling issues and fix those.
- 3. Make the main characters the subjects of sentences and use important action verbs as possible.
- 4. How well do your sentences flow? Put old information before new information in your sentences.
- 5. Delete unnecessary words and change negatives to affirmatives.
- 6. Read your work aloud again and revise to improve the shape and structure of your sentences.

Formatting Revisions

- 1. For this project, follow the formatting guidelines in Advanced Academic Writing II p.8-9.
- 2. Set your font to Times New Roman, size 12.
- 3. Be sure to add your Works Cited page as a separate page after your essay, and format it with hanging indents. Remember, you can look up anything online if you've forgotten how to double-space your paper, etc.

→ REFERENCE

Advanced Academic Writing II, p.16-39, includes some helpful information on common grammar and usage mistakes.

WEEK 12 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 141
Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
Steering the Craft

WEEK 12 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 142
Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
Communicating with Grace and Virtue

WEEK 12 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 143
Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
Composition Lessons

Composition: Grade 11

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WEEK 12 40m Composition: Grade 11 - Lesson 144 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: Composition Lessons	
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Examination

- Term 1**
- Steering the Craft: What can you say about “the sound of your writing,” “punctuation and grammar,” or “sentence length and complex syntax”?
 - Steering the Craft: Explain the use of repetition, rhythm, and echoes (structural repetition) in writing.
 - Name three logical fallacies you learned this term and give examples of each.
- Term 2**
- Steering the Craft: Tell why “the person and the tense of the verb matter.”
 - Steering the Craft: Explain the differences and use of point of view and voice in writing; give examples from this term's readings.
 - Why do citation systems exist? Explain plagiarism and how to avoid it.
- Term 3**
- Steering the Craft: Explain what Le Guin means by “the world is full of stories” and tell about “invisible exposition.”
 - Steering the Craft: Explain “Crowding and Leaping”.
 - Describe your favorite writing assignment from the term or year. Did you find that writing helped you think more deeply about your topic?